

held-out NLL bits / icon (↓ better modeling)

Most compressed ≠ best model

L1 (104 tok) models better than L1+BPE (59 tok) and char-BPE (159 tok)

char-BPE

L1 + more merges →

L1+BPE(1k)

L1

40

60

80

100

120

140

160

tokens / icon (← more compressed)

